FRANKLIN CHENG

San Jose, CA **(OPEN TO RELOCATION)** | (646) 858-7167 | franklin_cheng@outlook.com | LinkedIn | Portfolio

EDUCATION

M. S. in Human Factors and Ergonomics (UX Conc.), San Jose State University — August 2024 - Spring 2027
CGPA: 3.95 / 4.0

B. A. in Anthropology (Hons.), New York University — September 2021 - May 2023
Howard Levene (WSC '41) Research Scholar & Dean's Undergraduate Research Fund Grant

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Product Design Intern, The Kroger Co., Cincinnati, OH — May 2026 - Present

- Led the onboarding experience for Kroger's enterprise item management platform by designing a three-layer learning support framework for 10 role-specific user groups, enabling adoption of a mission-critical merchandising and supply chain system
- Collaborated with 4 Senior Product Designers and 5 Product Managers to define the platform's onboarding strategy, presenting the vision and implementation roadmap to 50+ cross-functional stakeholders to drive alignment across product, engineering, and business teams
- Designed two end-to-end enterprise workflows in Figma using Kroger's component-based design system, simplifying complex item management processes and improving operational efficiency
- Designed and implemented a role-aware AI onboarding assistant by developing custom prompts, knowledge context, and reusable AI skills, reducing support dependency and delivering personalized guidance during migration from legacy systems
- Conducted mixed-method UX research—including **journey mapping**, **contextual inquiry**, **interviews**, and **focus groups**—with 10+ user groups, synthesizing insights into actionable onboarding requirements that addressed workflow pain points and role-specific needs

Strategic Support Fellow, Wilmington Learning Collaborative, Wilmington, DE — June 2025 - August 2025

- Led a mixed-methods study of 18 citywide summer learning programs, assessing offerings, participation trends, and systemic challenges through **program observations**, **semi-structured interviews**, and **surveys**
- Synthesized findings into actionable insights for a statewide education strategy, presenting recommendations directly to the mayor, senators, and education leaders across multiple school districts in DE and PA; research findings were later featured on a statewide news channel
- Designed evaluation timelines, benchmarks, and KPIs to guide $1.5M in summer learning funding, supporting long-term measurement of academic ROI for the Wilmington Learning Collaborative

User Study Moderator, Apple Inc., Cupertino, CA — January 2025 - June 2025

- Led and supported usability studies, collaborating cross-functionally with researchers, project managers, and operations teams to identify user pain points and improve product experience
- Conducted **user interviews**, **usability testing**, and **data collection setup**, ensuring methodological rigor and high-quality insights
- Managed end-to-end data collection, from participant recruitment and informed consent to supervising sessions, safeguarding confidential data, and reviewing datasets for quality assurance and reporting

User Experience Consultant, dfusion Inc., Remote — October 2024 - January 2025

- Conducted UX research—including **heuristic evaluation**, **usability testing**, and **semi-structured interviews**—to identify key user pain points and inefficiencies in the user flow of an EdTech solution designed to gamify math learning for middle school students
- Designed wireframes, mockups, and interactive prototypes for the core dashboards and student-facing interfaces—now launched across 10 school districts nationwide
- Initiated competitor research to identify trends and gaps in supplementary educational curricula, reaching out to local public school districts to understand classroom needs and inform product development

ENTREPRENEURIAL PROJECT

Hao's House (Home Bakery) – Owner — August 2023 - Present

- Built a community of 500+ loyal customers on various social media platforms, resulting in $2,000+ average monthly sales with a 90% customer return rate while balancing full-time studies and another part-time job

SKILLS

Research: Project Management, Research Operations, Usability Evaluation, Interviews, Ethnography, Surveys, Metrics Design
Leadership & Collaboration: Empathy, Active Listening, Stakeholder Management & Communication, Agile Collaboration
Tools: SPSS, MAXQDA, Figma, Mural, Miro, Notion, Confluence, Qualtrics, Adobe Creative Suite, Microsoft Office Suite